

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Category boundary

LAKE -> standing water in an inland basin

RESERVOIR -> artificial or strongly regulated storage

WETLAND -> broader hydrological-ecological category

RAMSAR SITE -> international designation, not basin origin

MUST REMEMBER: Lake classification must follow basin origin—tectonic, volcanic, glacial, fluvial, karst, coastal, aeolian, landslide or artificial—then water balance, mixing, sediment and succession; Indian wetlands add Ramsar and domestic-governance layers.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Lake-origin tree

EARTH MOVEMENT -> tectonic or volcanic basin

ICE / RIVER / COAST -> tarn, ox-bow or lagoon

BLOCKAGE / IMPACT -> landslide dam or crater

HUMAN WORK -> reservoir, bund or excavation

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Water-budget equation

INPUT -> rain + river + groundwater

OUTPUT -> evaporation + outflow + seepage

STORAGE CHANGE -> inputs minus outputs

ATTRIBUTION -> state period, basin and uncertainty

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Lake-change firewall

SUCCESSION -> sediment and organic infilling

EUTROPHICATION -> nutrient-productivity-oxygen shift

SHRINKAGE -> water-budget deficit

RULE -> similar appearance can hide different mechanisms

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Wetland hydroperiod

TIMING -> season of inundation

DURATION -> how long water remains

DEPTH + FREQUENCY -> habitat filter

CONNECTIVITY -> river, aquifer or coast link

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: India lake map

WULAR -> Jhelum-linked Kashmir basin

SAMBHAR -> saline Rajasthan closed basin

CHILIKA -> Odisha coastal lagoon

LONAR / KANWAR / BHOJ -> impact / fluvial / artificial

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: River-lake traps

WULAR -> linked to Jhelum

KOLLERU -> between Krishna and Godavari deltas

LOKTAK -> phumdi-bearing lake

RULE -> adjacency does not prove direct feeding

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Urban reclamation chain

FILL / NARROW -> storage and drainage lost

RUNOFF -> flood peak and duration rise

POLLUTION -> dilution and habitat decline

EQUITY -> low-lying communities bear shifted risk

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Threat-response matrix

SEWAGE / NUTRIENT -> source control + treatment

SEDIMENT -> catchment and erosion management

ENCROACHMENT -> protect hydrological space

INVASIVE / ALTERED FLOW -> ecological and flow restoration

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Ramsar status firewall

CRITERION -> at least one can support listing

WISE USE -> maintain ecological character

MONTREUX -> priority attention to character change

LIMIT -> listing is not automatic National Park status

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Lake, lagoon, oxbow, reservoir and wetland are not synonyms;
freshwater/saline and exorheic/endorheic are separate axes, while Ramsar designation is international recognition rather than ownership transfer or automatic protection.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: India governance chain

INVENTORY -> identify and delineate system

NOTIFICATION / RULES -> regulate activities

PLAN / NPCA -> finance and implement management

MONITOR -> prove ecological response

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Area, designation count and ecological status are time-sensitive; shrinkage or eutrophication needs inflow, evaporation, abstraction, nutrients, encroachment and catchment evidence rather than one-cause attribution.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Lake-wetland answer spine

DEFINE -> basin, wetland and status

CLASSIFY -> origin and hydrology

DIAGNOSE -> budget, nutrient or connectivity failure

RESPOND -> basin-scale, monitored and status-aware